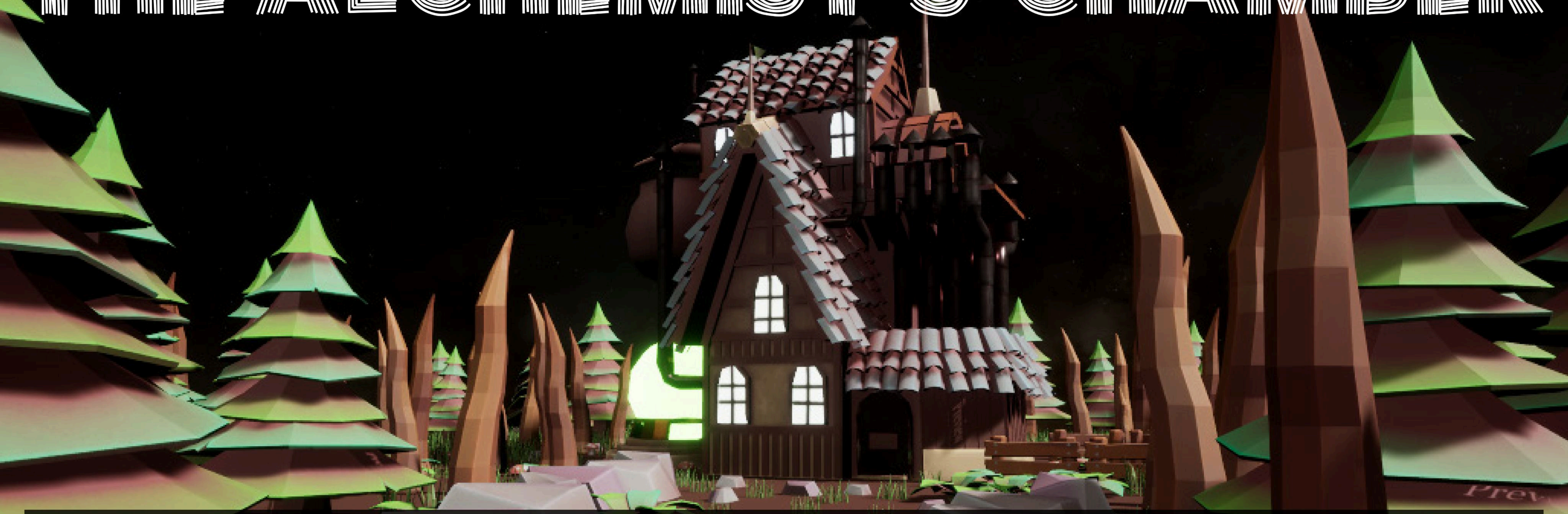
THE ALCHEMIST'S CHAMBER



This project is a 3D visual scene created using Unreal Engine 5. Through the combination of meticulous modelling and dynamic lighting, it crafts a virtual environment rich in contrast and metaphor. The scene's focal point is a pristine, elegant boat adorned with lush greenery, resembling a self-sustaining oasis as it glides across a polluted sea surface littered with dead fish and decaying marine life.

This vessel symbolises humanity's constructed "ideal living environment" - orderly and verdant - yet stands in stark visual and emotional contrast to the fragmented natural ecology surrounding it. Through this extreme juxtaposition, the project satirises contemporary society's fixation on personal cleanliness and comfort while turning a blind eye, or even remaining utterly oblivious, to the destruction and collapse of the larger environment - Mother Nature.

The entire work transcends mere visual presentation, functioning as a metaphorical critique of environmental issues. Leveraging the immersive qualities of virtual reality, it prompts viewers to reconsider humanity's relationship with nature: if our 'oasis' is built upon indifference to the external world, how long can it endure? This microcosm poses a profound inquiry into modern environmental ethics while offering an artistic rebuttal to anthropocentric perspectives.

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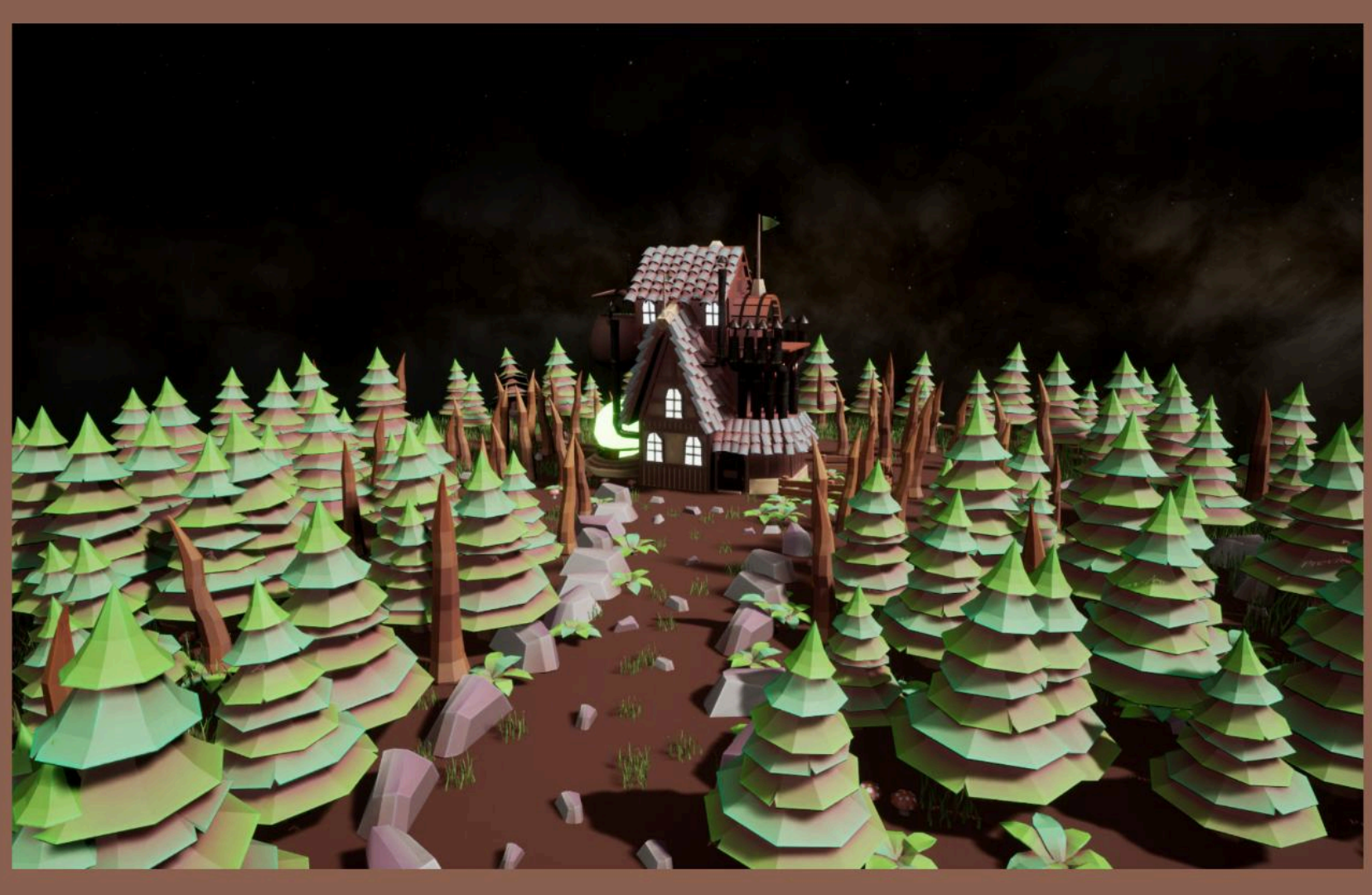
INSPIRATION

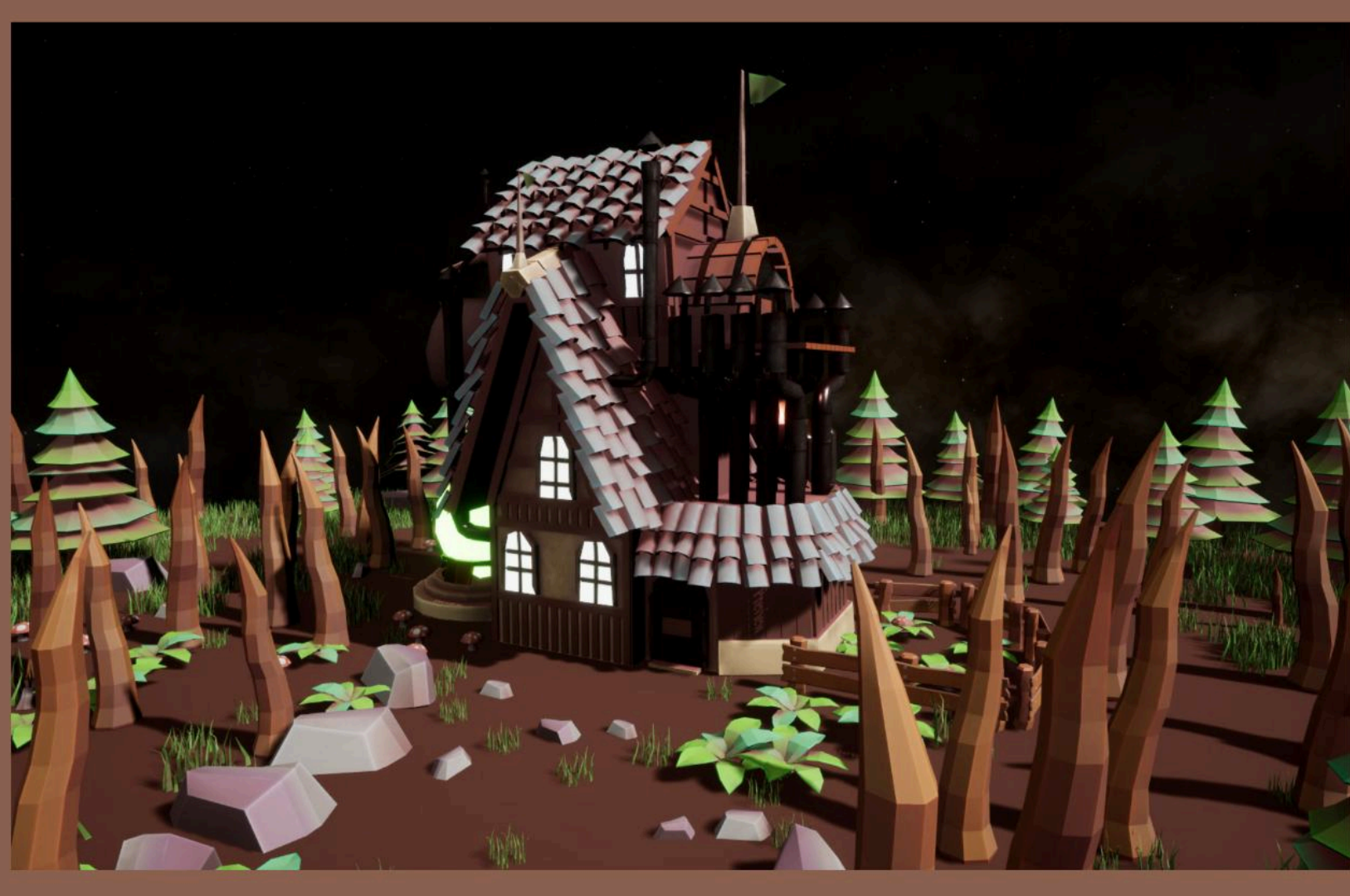
Inspiration: The Philosopher's Stone and the Paradox of Nature

In the Middle Ages, alchemists were obsessed with the Philosopher's Stone, believing it could transmute base metals into gold and bestow eternal life. Yet this pursuit was fundamentally an expression of humanity's desire to reshape and control nature - an extreme manifestation of our yearning to transcend natural laws. Simultaneously, the countless failed experiments and piles of waste materials within alchemical laboratories symbolised the vast chasm between desire and truth.

To address this contradiction, I constructed multiple 3D environments within Unreal Engine 5: an alchemical workshop featuring a sloping roof and chimney, surrounded by forests and spiked pine trees, with an interior cluttered with flasks and apparatus. The workshop appears orderly, embodying the alchemist's ideals and fantasies; yet its surroundings are strewn with wreckage and traces of failure, hinting at the cost behind the pursuit of truth and desire.

Through these detailed 3D models—where spiked trees symbolise natural order, the workshop itself embodies human ambition, and debris hints at a cycle of decay—the work creates a potent contrast within the virtual space. It serves both as a recreation of medieval alchemical fantasy and as a metaphorical critique of humanity's boundaries of knowledge and ethical relationship with nature.

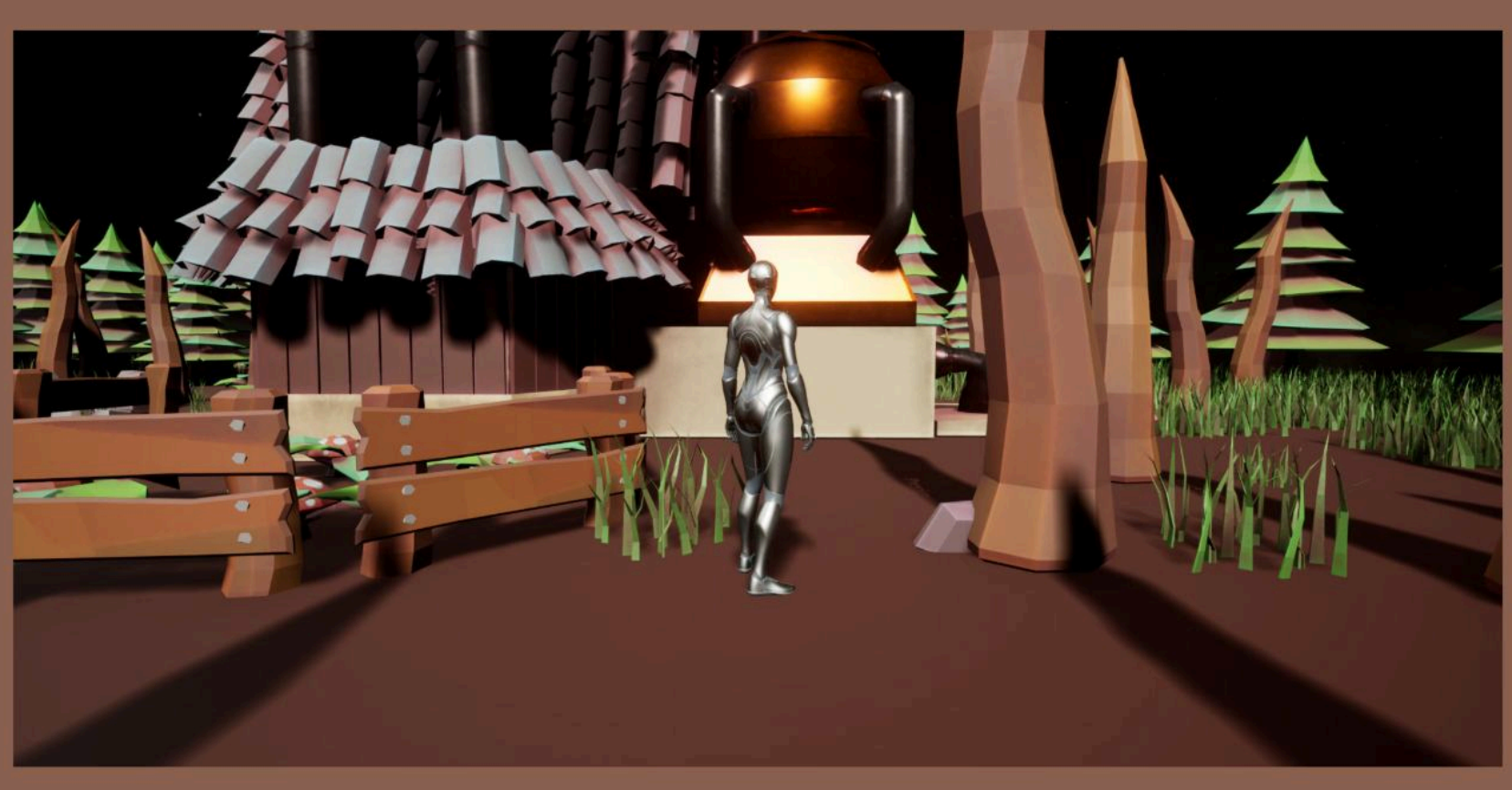


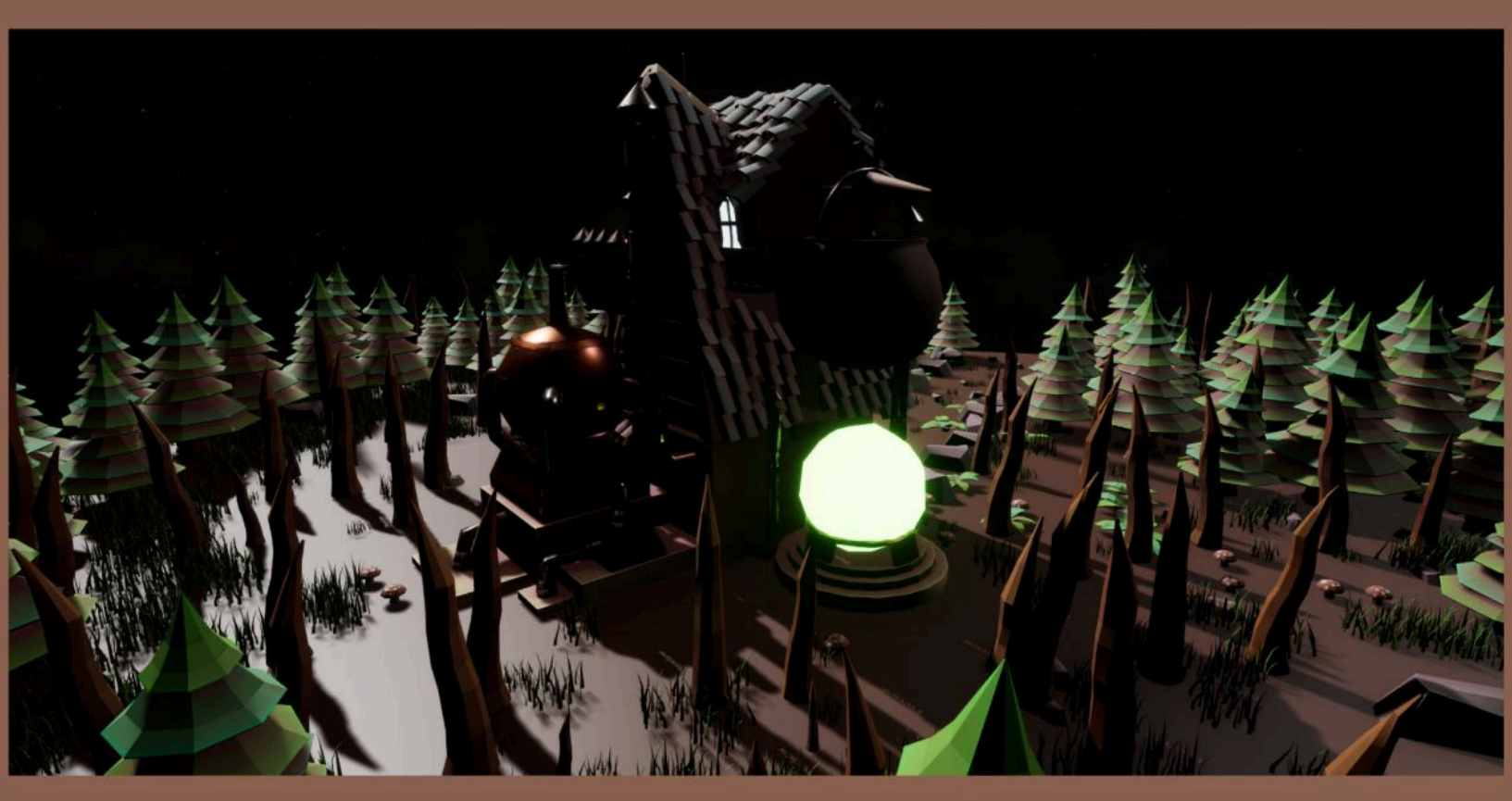


STORY BACKGROUND

At the edge of the Galactic Ruins lies an uninhabited forest known as Starwood.
It is a world's remnant swallowed by a temporal fissure: trees, rocks, and air all frozen in the form of polygonal fragments. At the forest's centre stands an isolated structure, The Chrono House, emitting green energy.

Legend holds that this structure was an experimental tower built by ancient scientists to store 'fragments of consciousness'. It could digitise human memories and rebirth them within an AI.
Yet after an energy catastrophe, all data was swallowed, leaving only an empty shell and a house adrift.

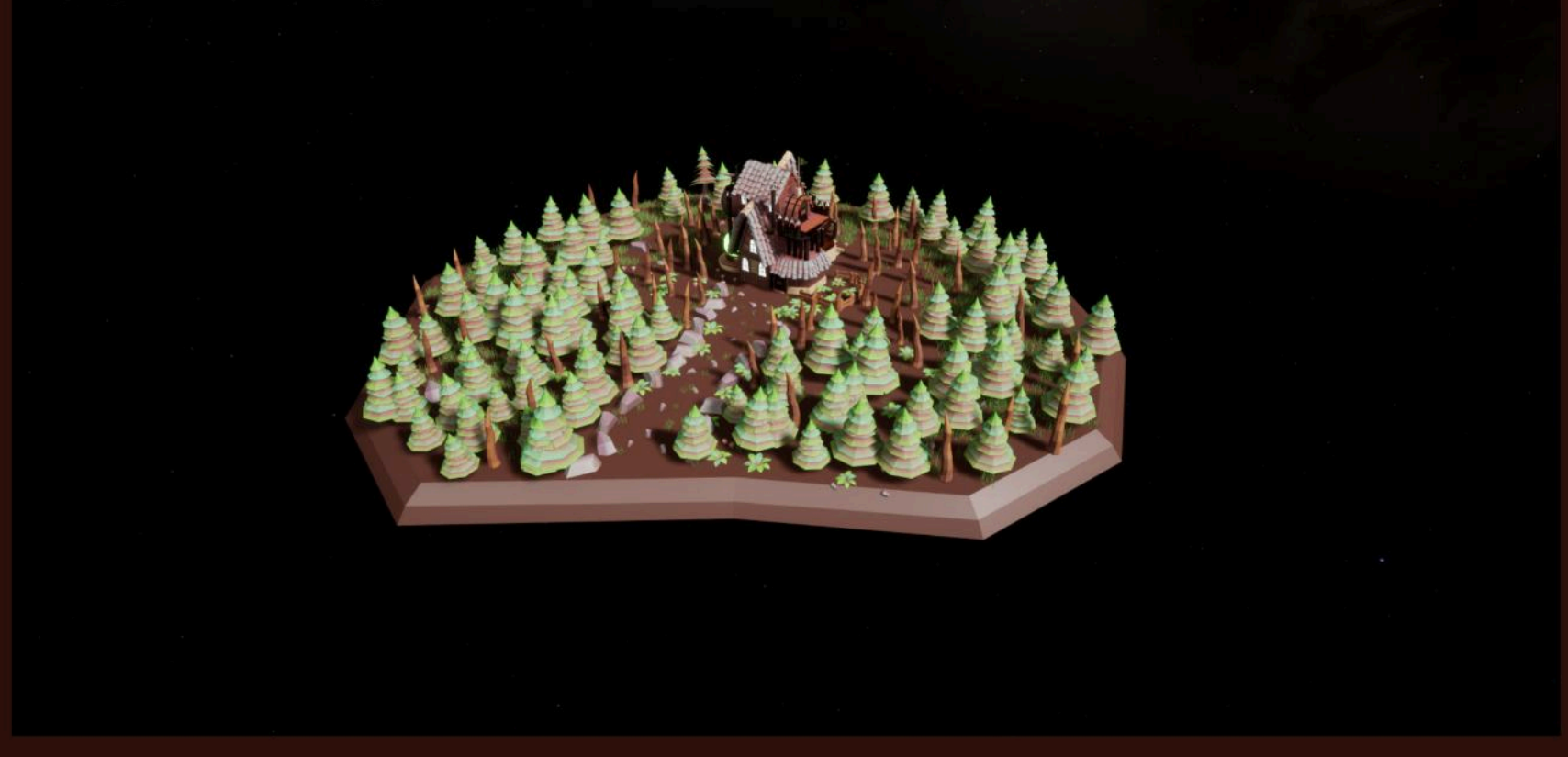


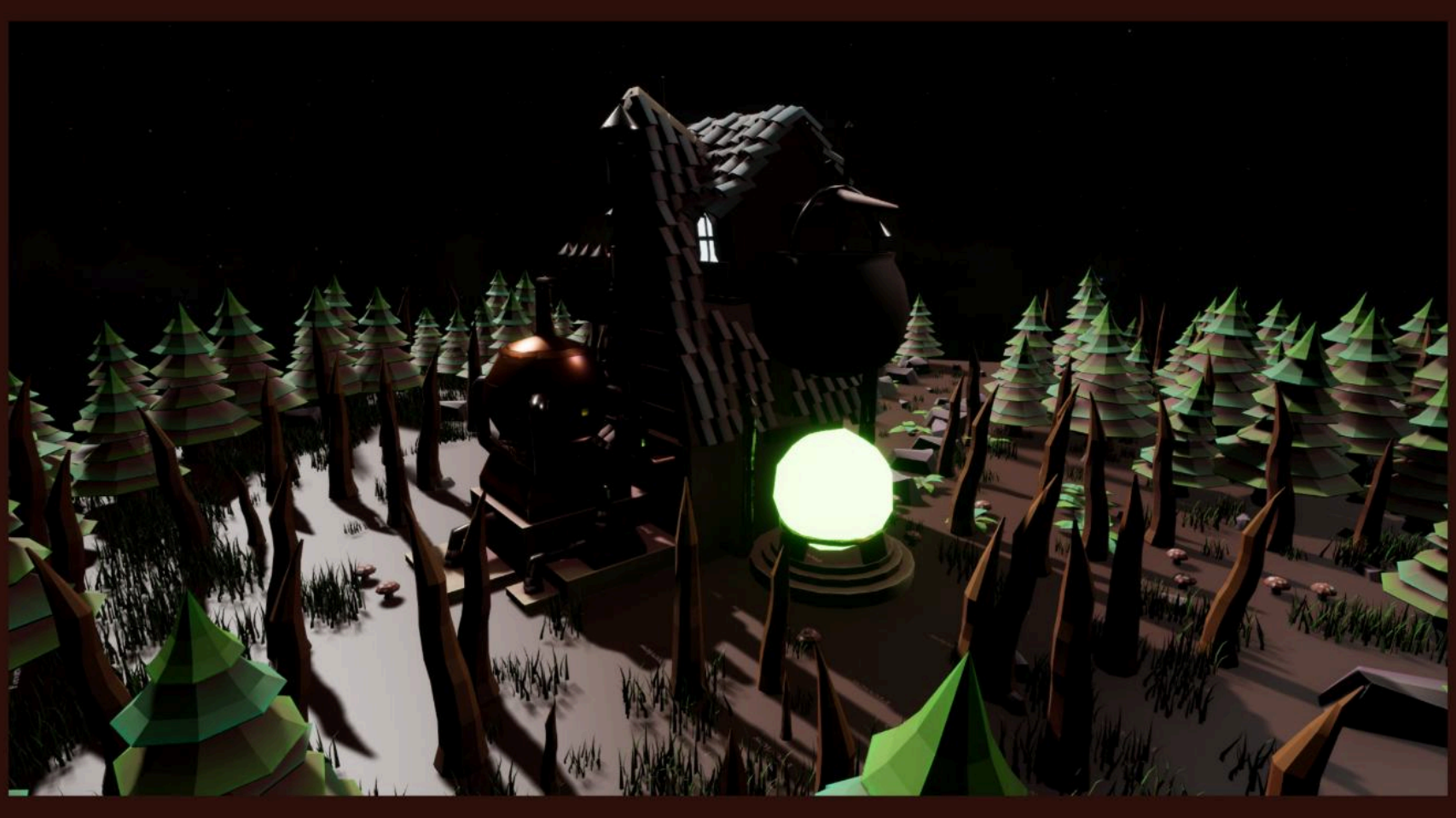


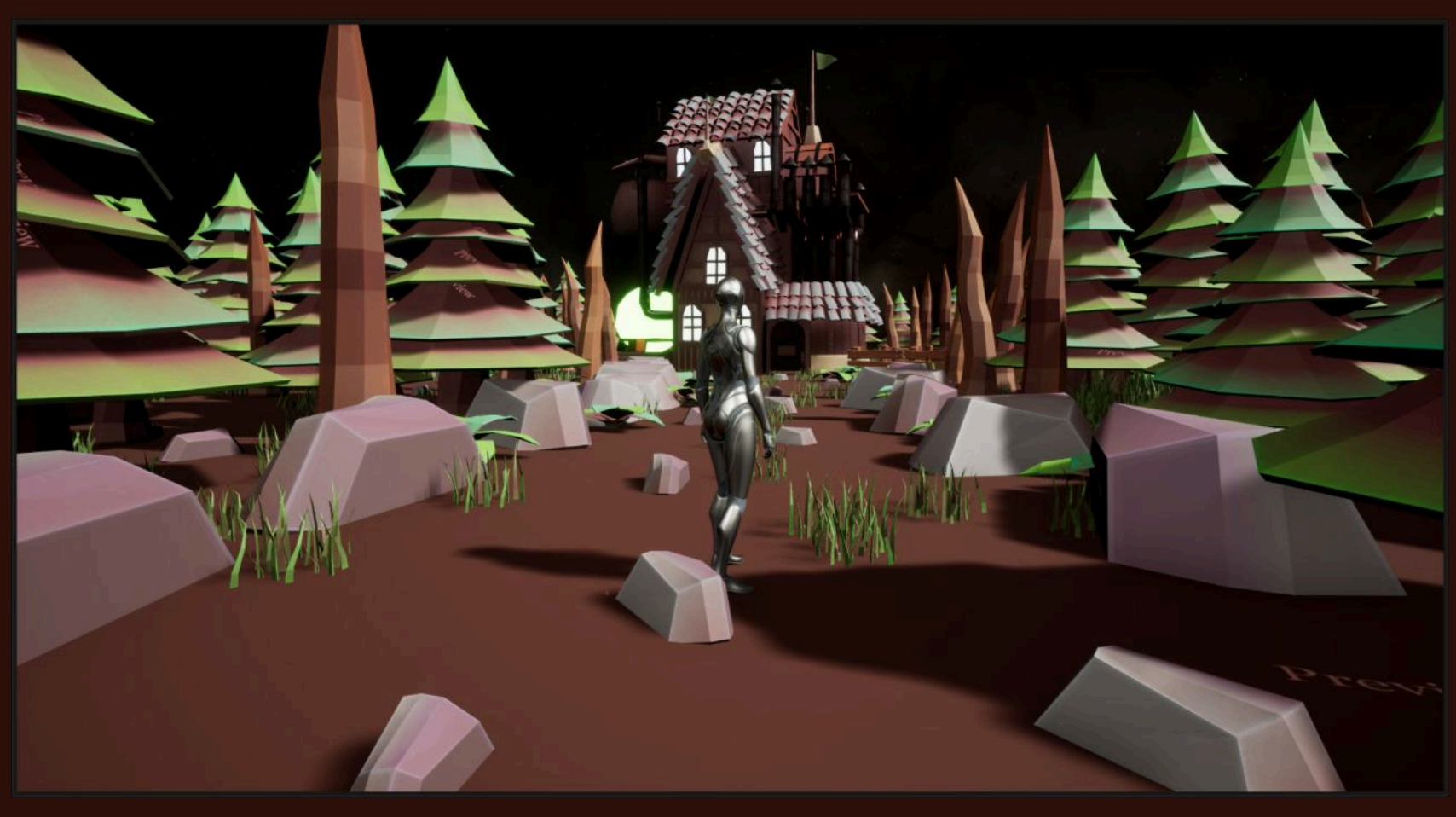
THEME AND ATMOSPHERE

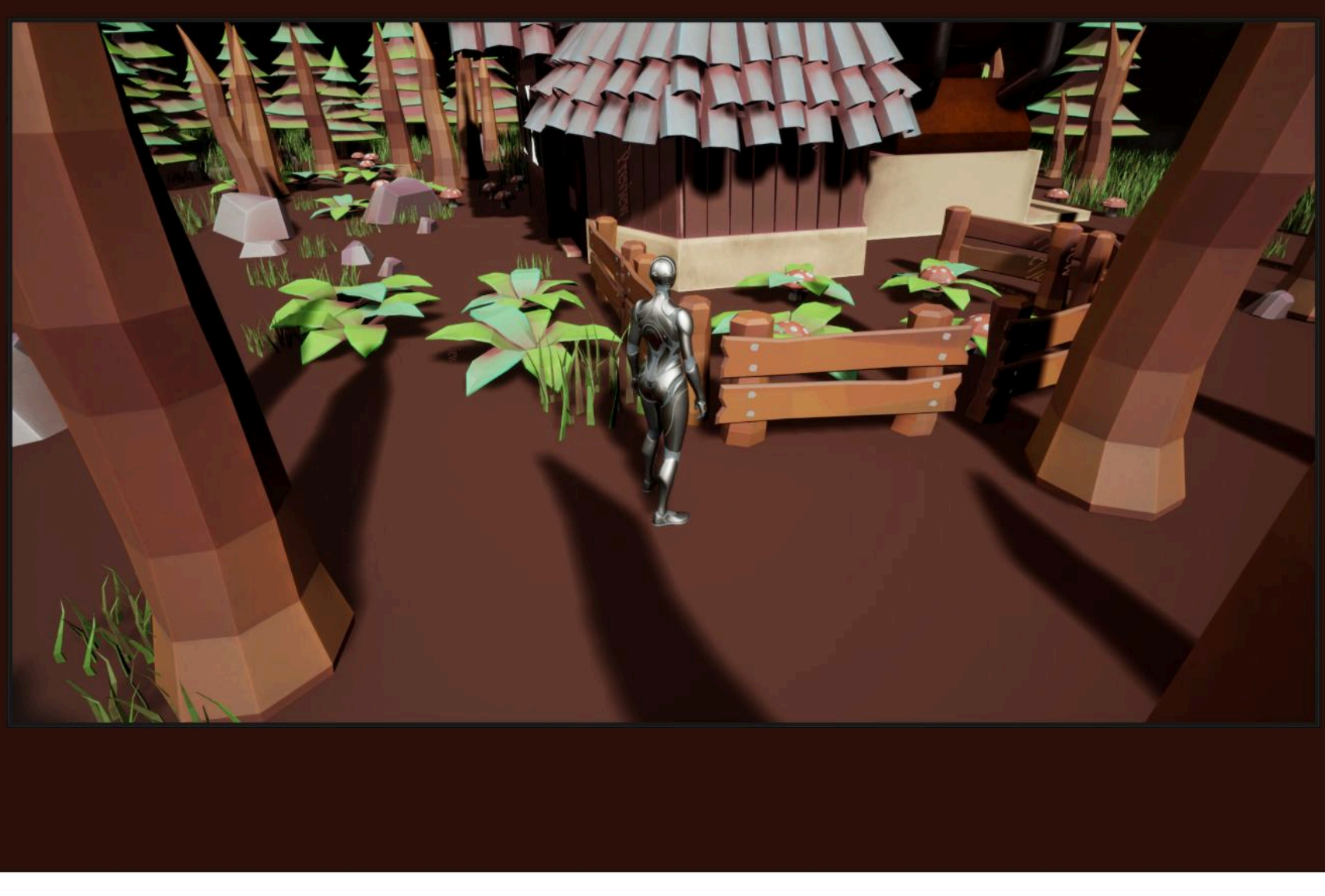
Solitude and Consciousness: What constitutes "being alive"? Is it memory, or sustained action?
Time Loop: Players exploring the same scene repeatedly will notice subtle alterations in its layout, hinting that memory is altering reality.
Visual Style: Low-poly textures, cool-toned contrasts and starry skies evoke "mystery within tranquillity".

SCENE DISPLAY









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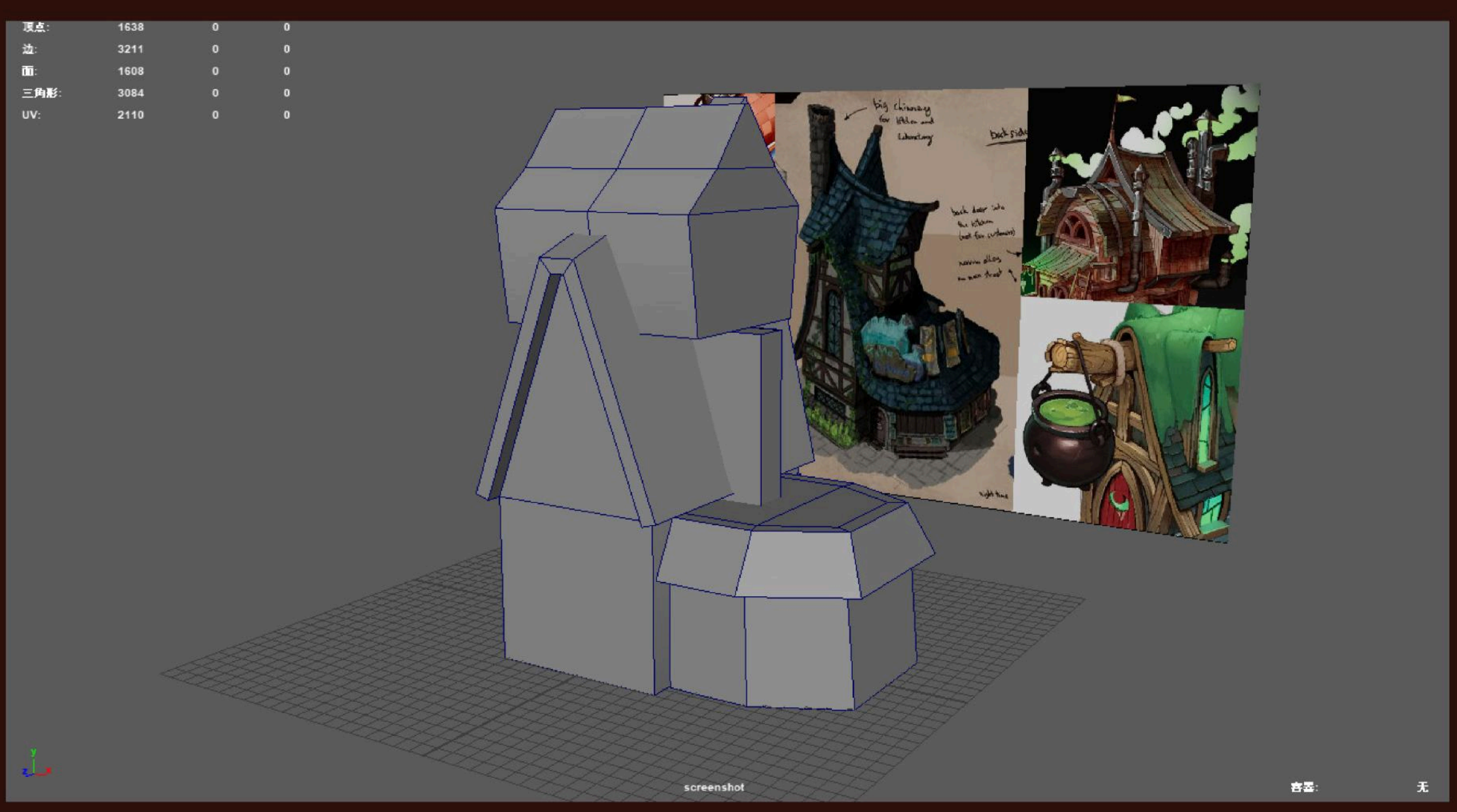
VERSION-1 → VERSION-4

VERSION-1



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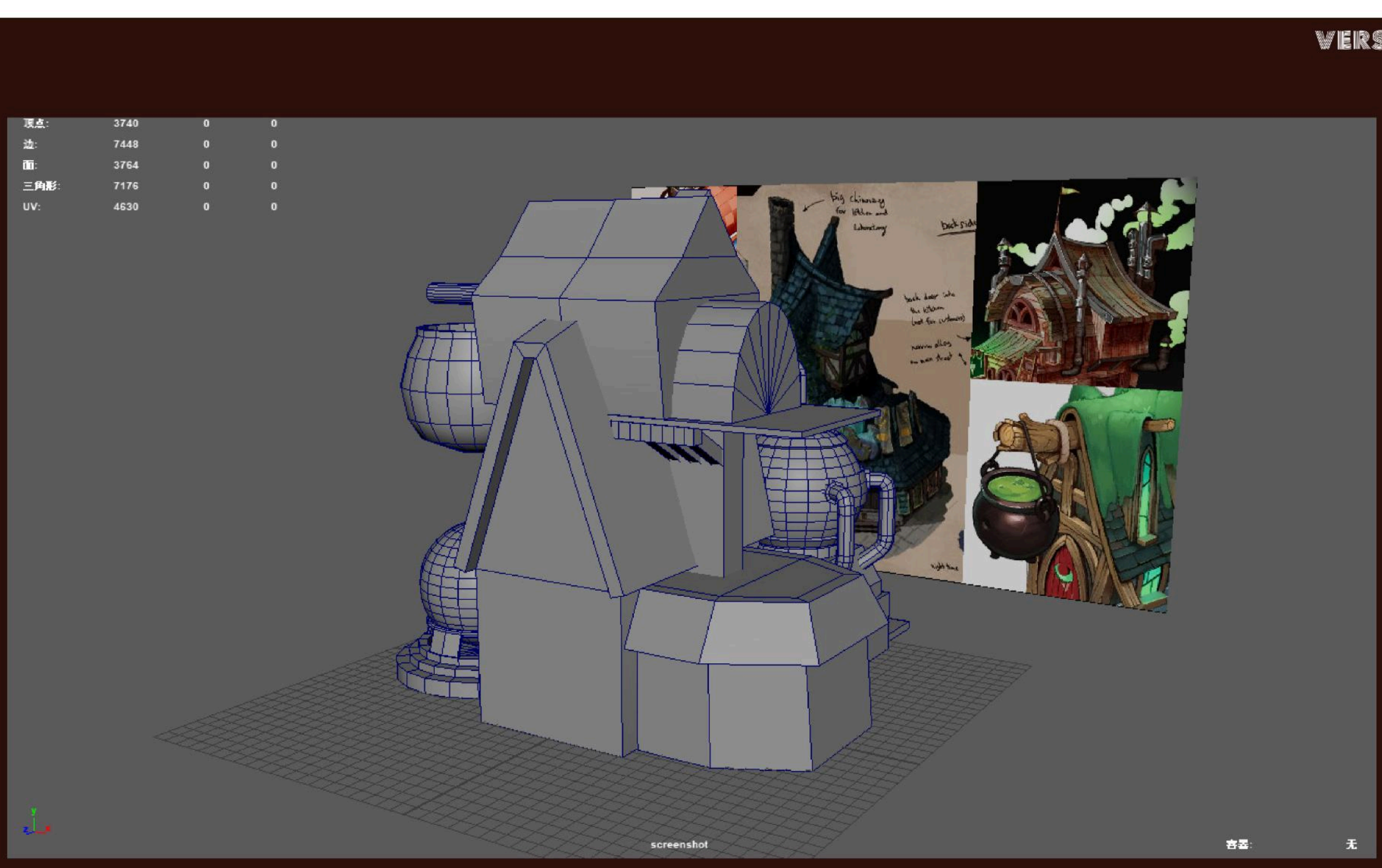

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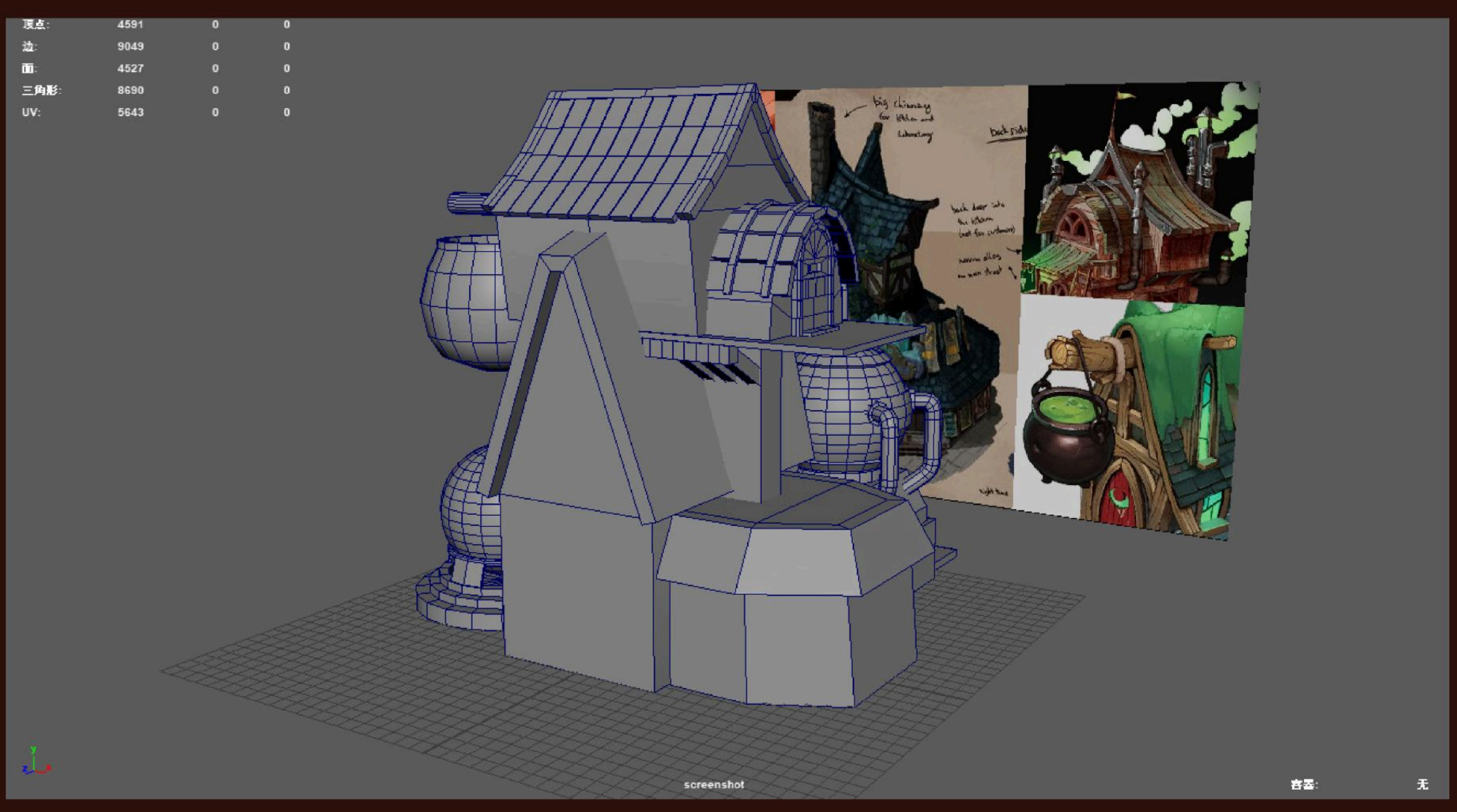
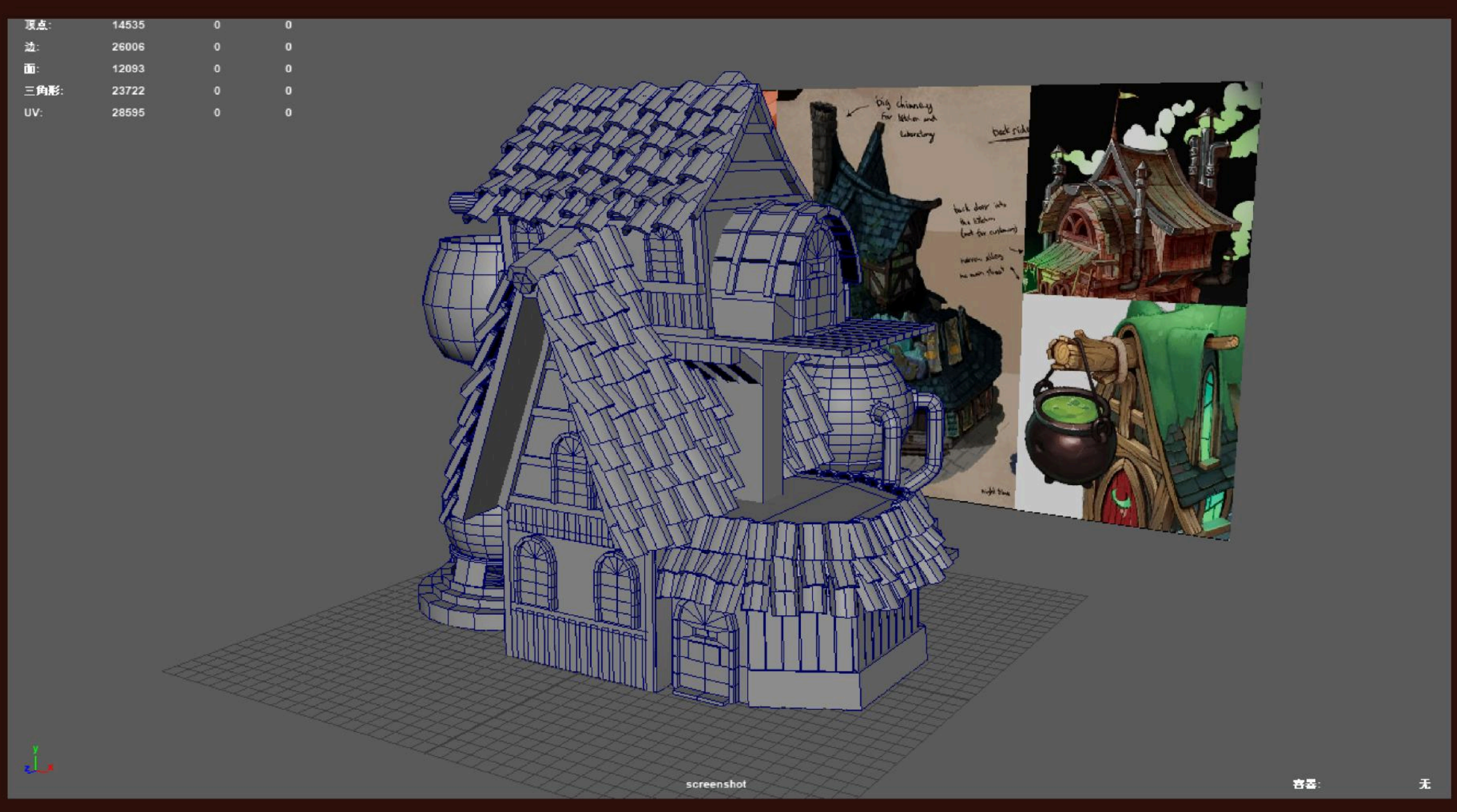


VERSION-4



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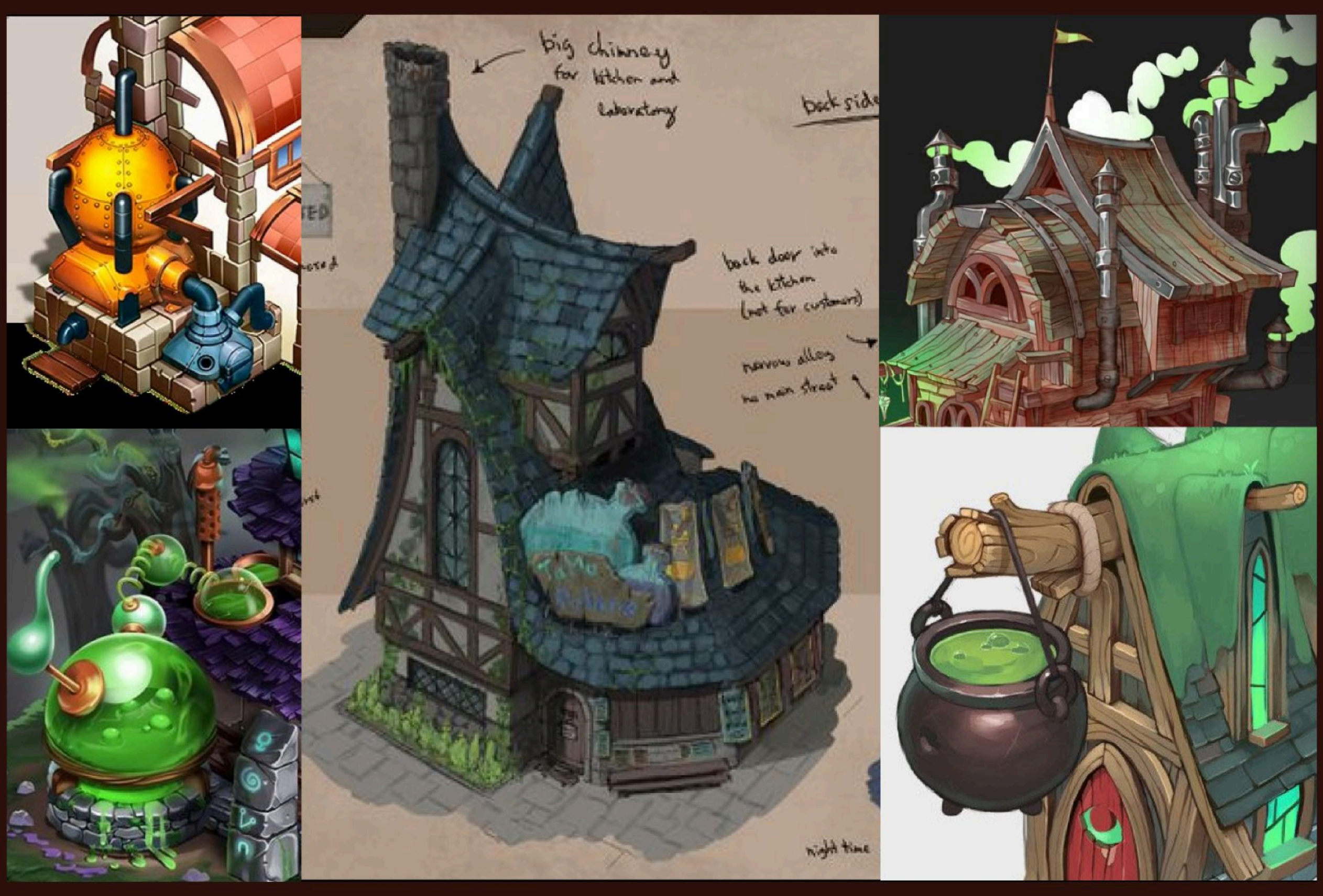
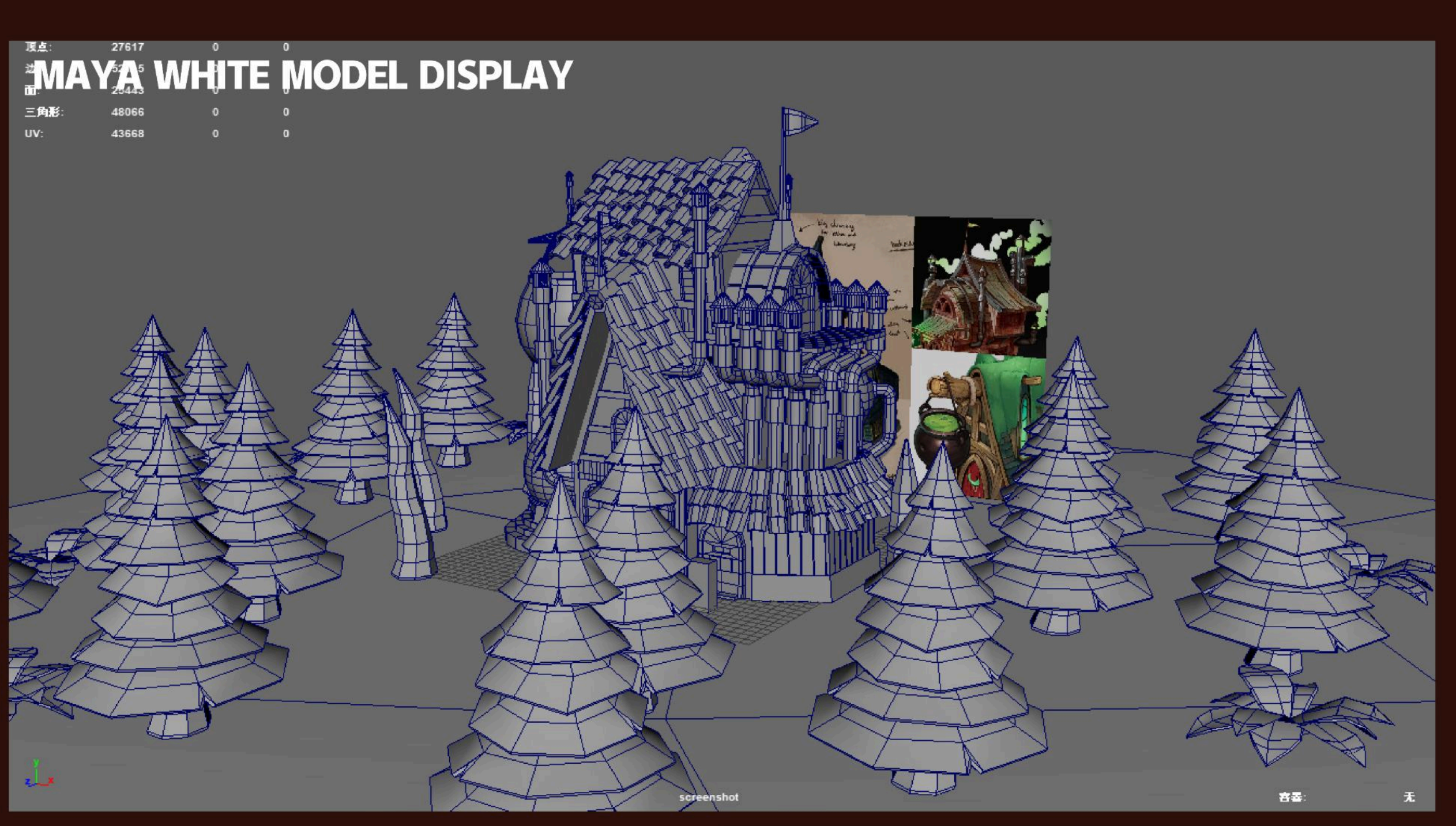
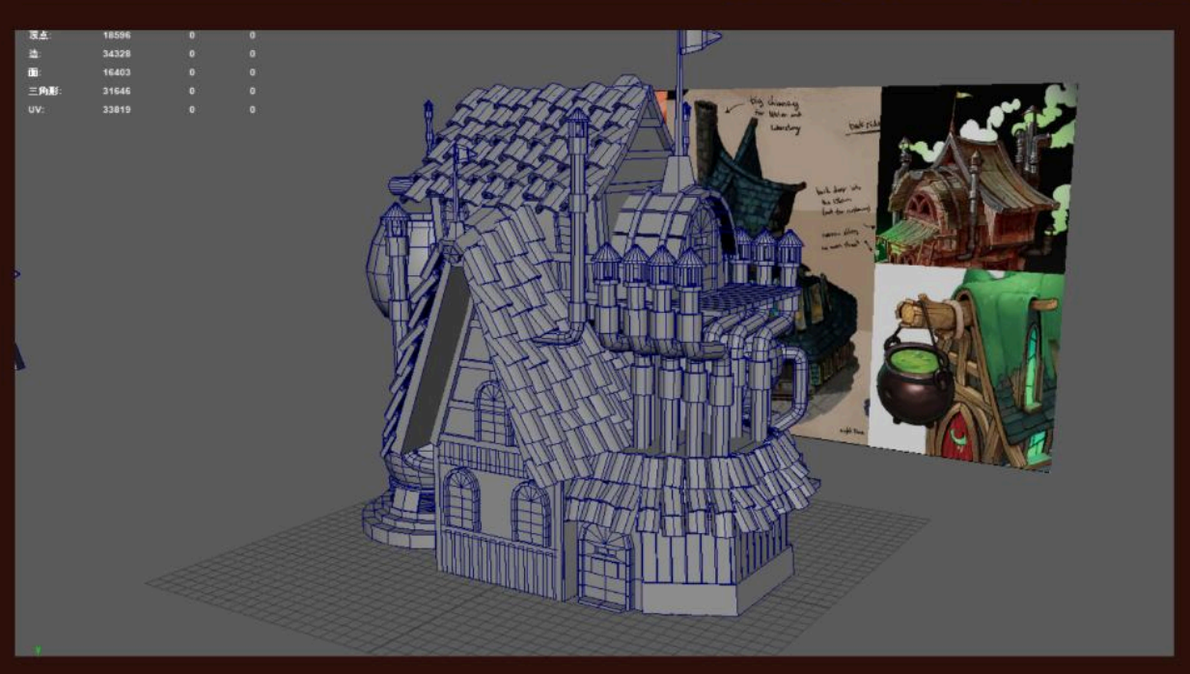
GENERAL ENVIRONMENTAL REFERENCES

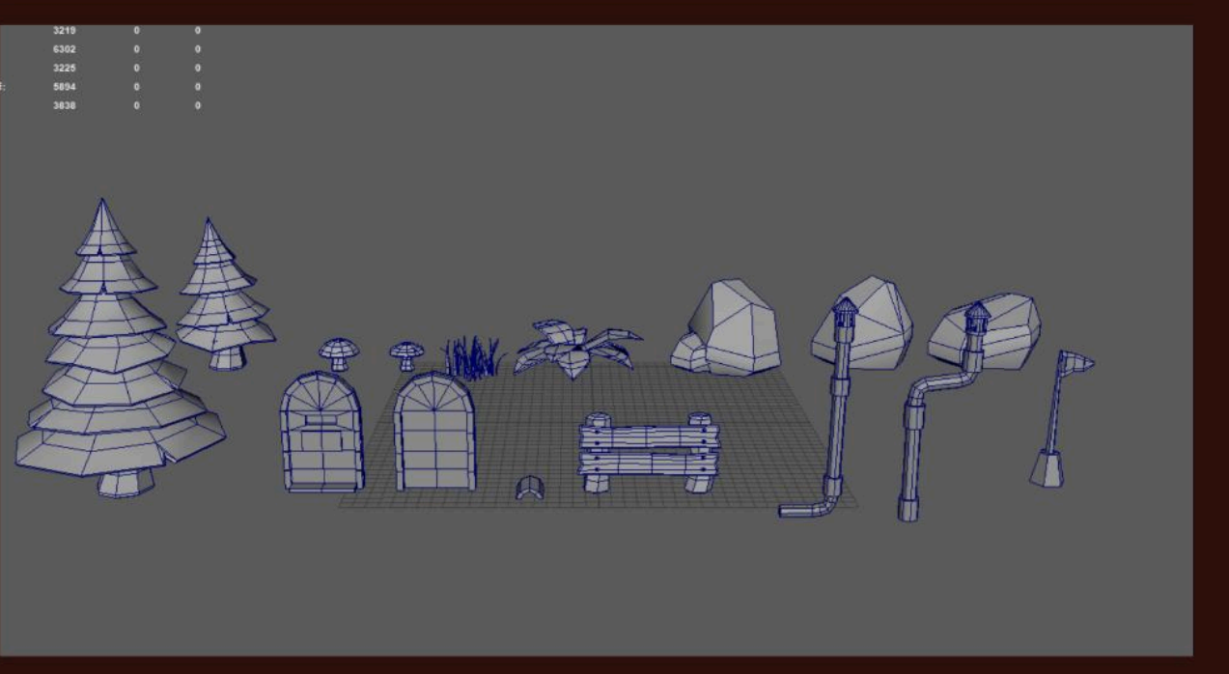
OVERALL STYLE


big chimney for kitchen and laboratory
back side
back door into the kitchen (not for customers)
narrow alley to main street
right face

MAYA WHITE MODEL DISPLAY







SUBSTANCE PAINTER DISPLAY